

Barood Khana (Gunpowder Magazine)

بارود خانہ

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: British colonial administration
- Built in: 1857 CE
- Cost: Not documented
- Built for: Storage of gunpowder and other ordnance

2. Construction Details

- Materials/technique: Not documented in available sources
- Context: Historic maps indicate a garden with arcades previously occupied this location before the Barood Khana replaced it; a road was later built between the Hathi Gate and the Diwan-i-Aam sector during the British period

3. Historical Background

- Represents the fort's conversion, under British rule, from a Mughal and Sikh royal residence into a functioning military installation - a decorative Mughal-period garden was literally replaced by an ammunition store.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- Its construction date of 1857 places it in the same year as the wider South Asian uprising against British rule, though no direct connection between the two is documented in available sources - the coincidence is worth noting but not overstating.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

Where a Mughal-era garden with shaded arcades once stood, the British Empire built a gunpowder store instead - a small, physical summary of how the fort's whole purpose shifted, garden by garden, room by room, from royal residence to military asset under colonial rule.